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Householder

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(54) **GOLF SWING BRACER**

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A63B 69/36 (2006.01)

(52) **U.S. Cl.**
CPC **A63B 69/3608** (2013.01); **A63B 2209/00**
(2013.01)

(58) **Field of Classification Search**
CPC **A63B 69/3608**; **A63B 2209/00**
USPC **473/205–207, 213, 409**
See application file for complete search history.

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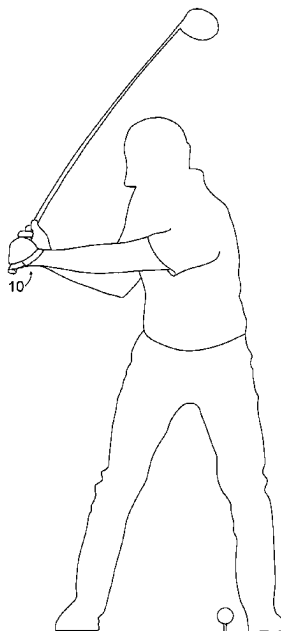
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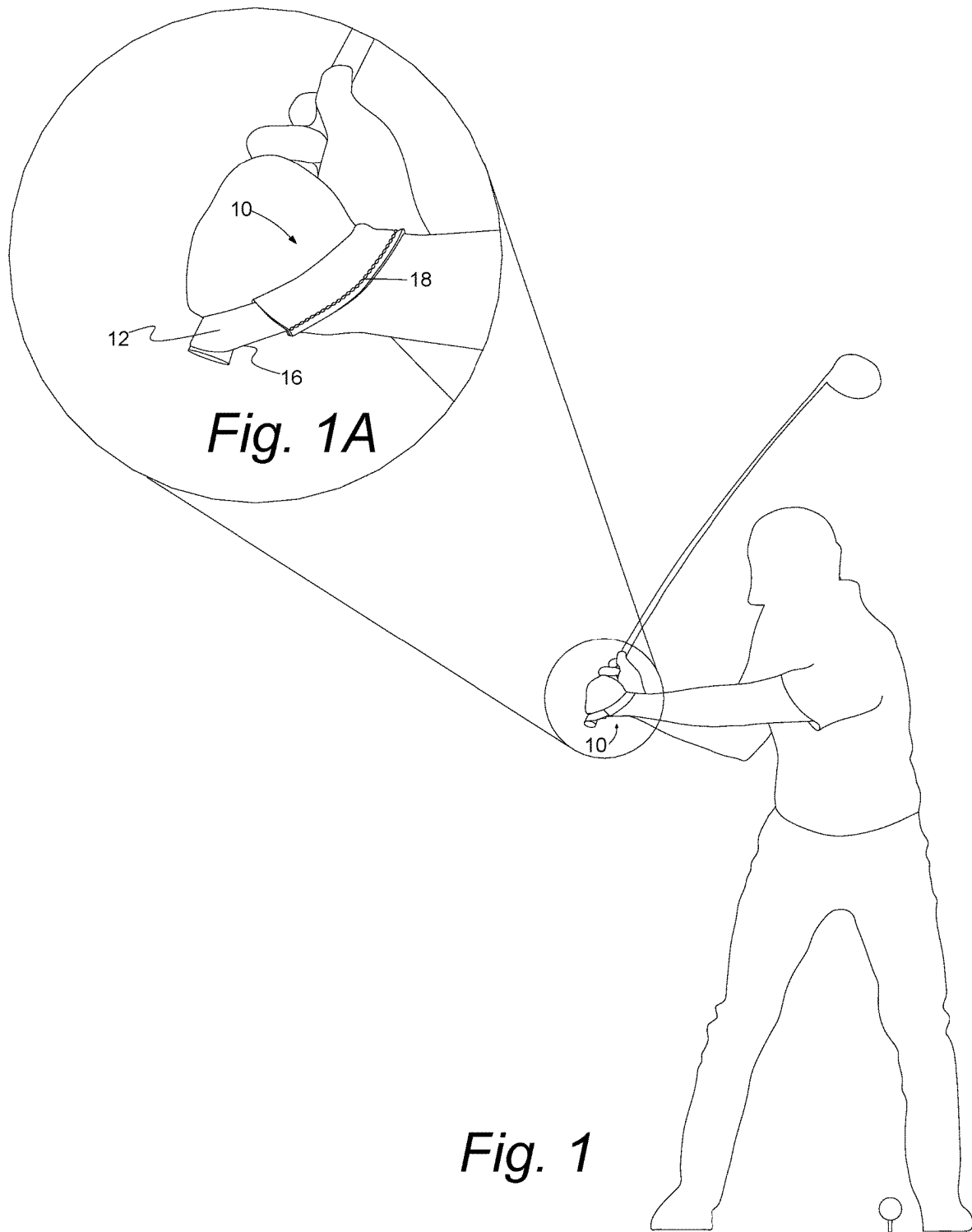
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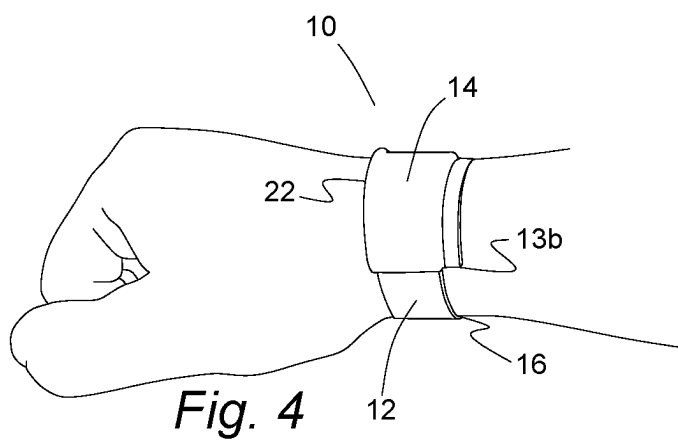
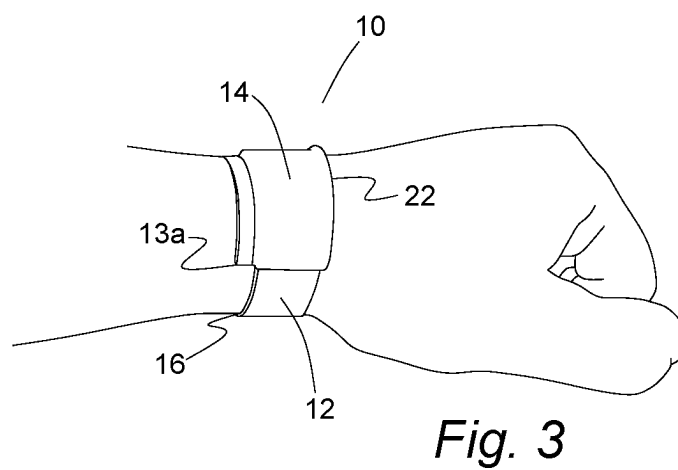
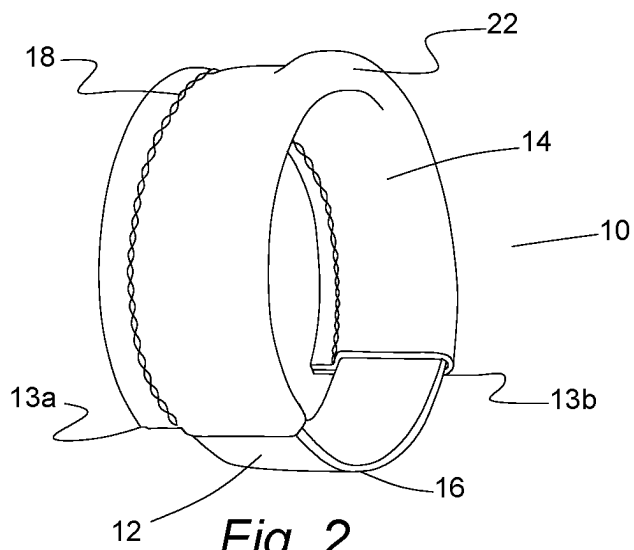
(57) **ABSTRACT**

A gripping method for holding a golf club grip comprising slipping a bracer with a band formed of an elastic material such as silicone over a golfer's lead hand and worn on the wrist. The bracer having a soft, breathable sheath that partially encircles the band with a gap between first and second ends. Stretching and releasing the band over the golf club grip such that the exposed elastic within the gap of the sheath has a hold on the golf club grip and the sheath pads the back of the golfer's hand. The method improving control of the golf club, improving hand gripping strength, and improving and consisicizing proper ulnar and radial deviation of the wrist during a golf swing.

4 Claims, 6 Drawing Sheets







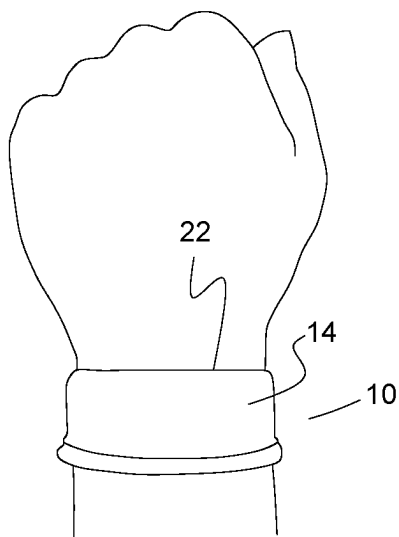


Fig. 5

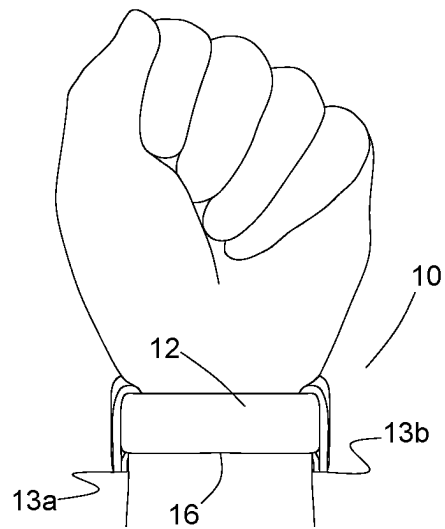


Fig. 7

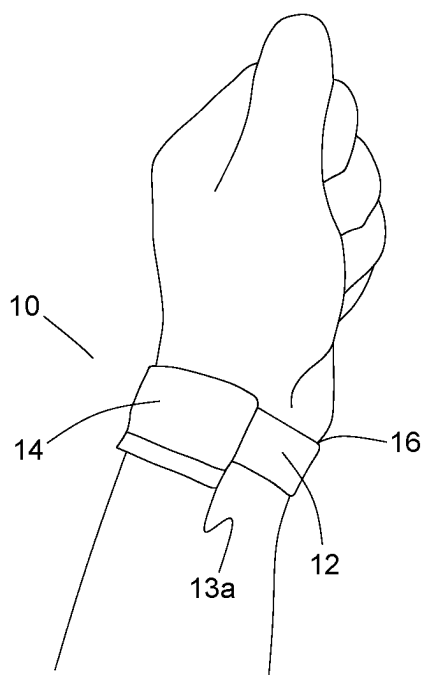


Fig. 6

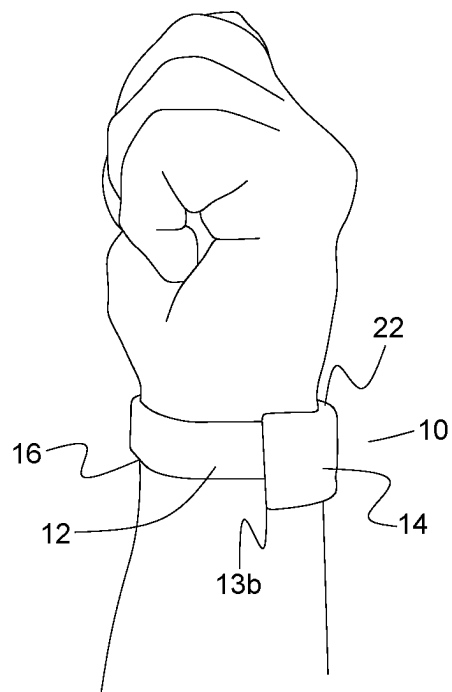
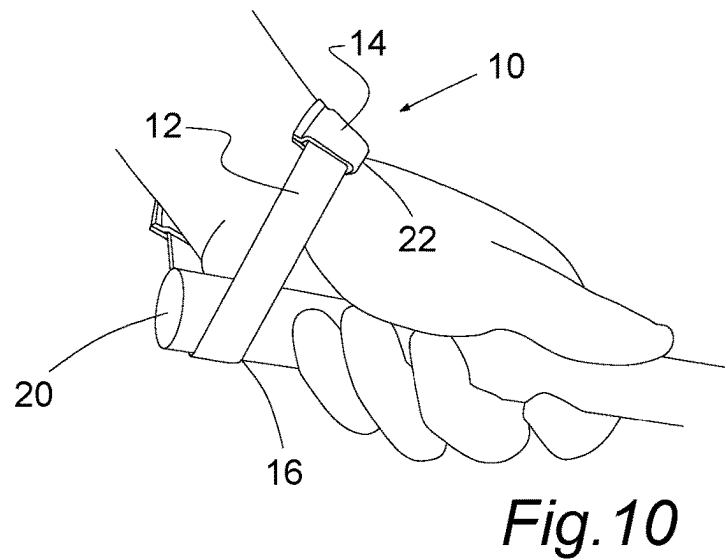
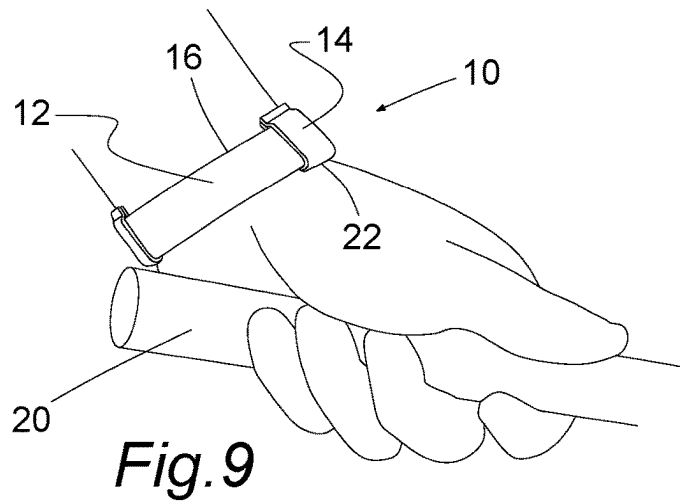


Fig. 8



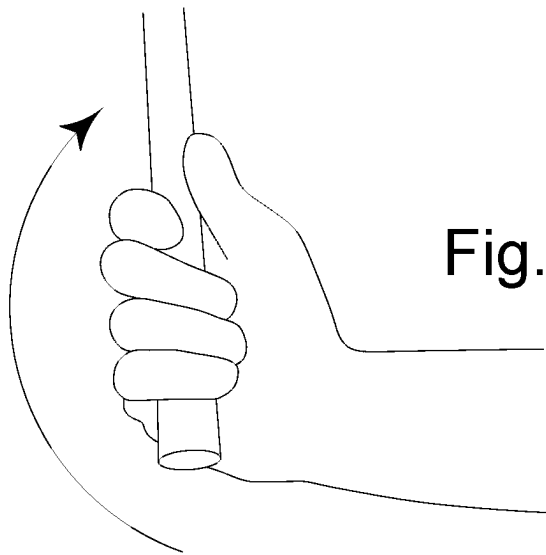


Fig. 11

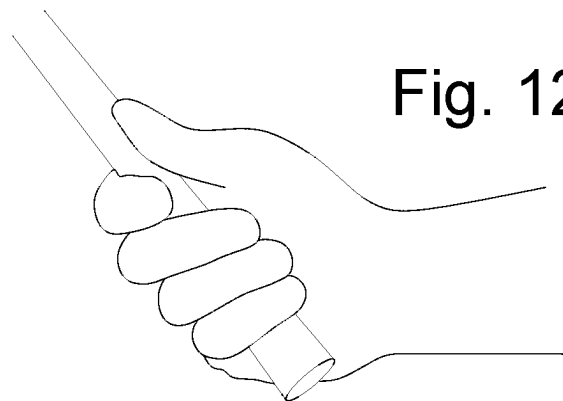


Fig. 12

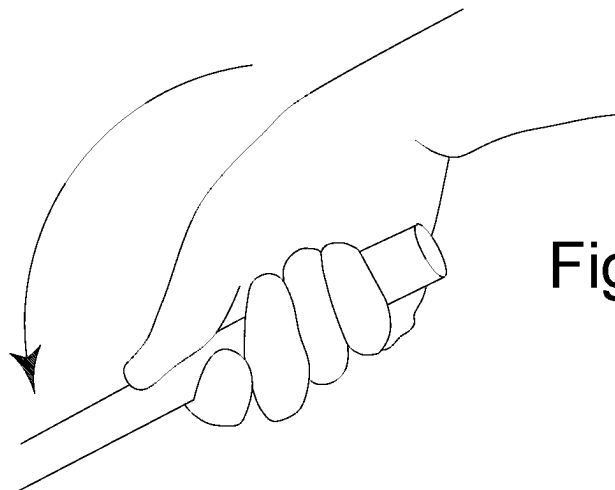


Fig. 13

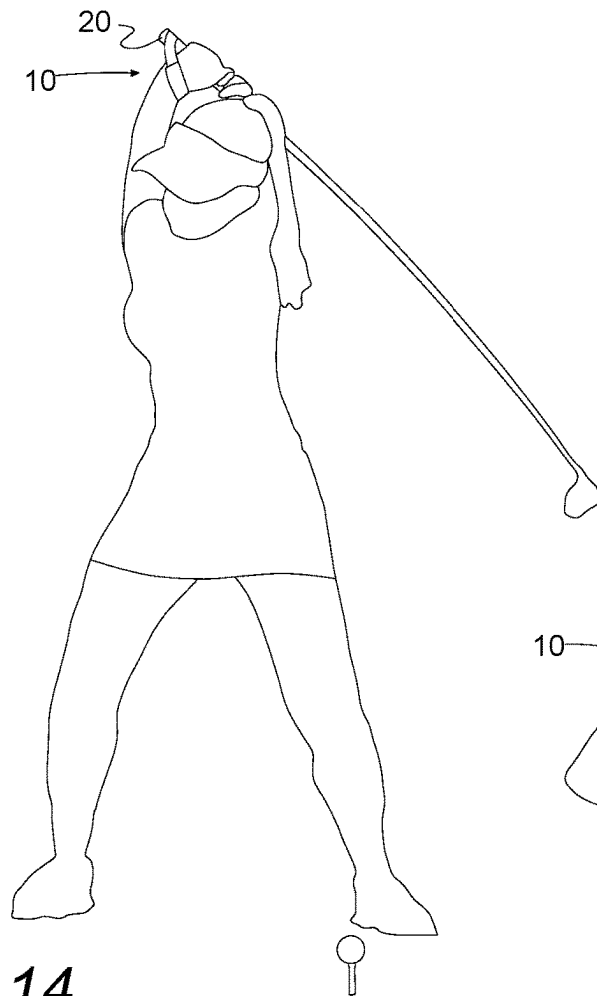


Fig. 14

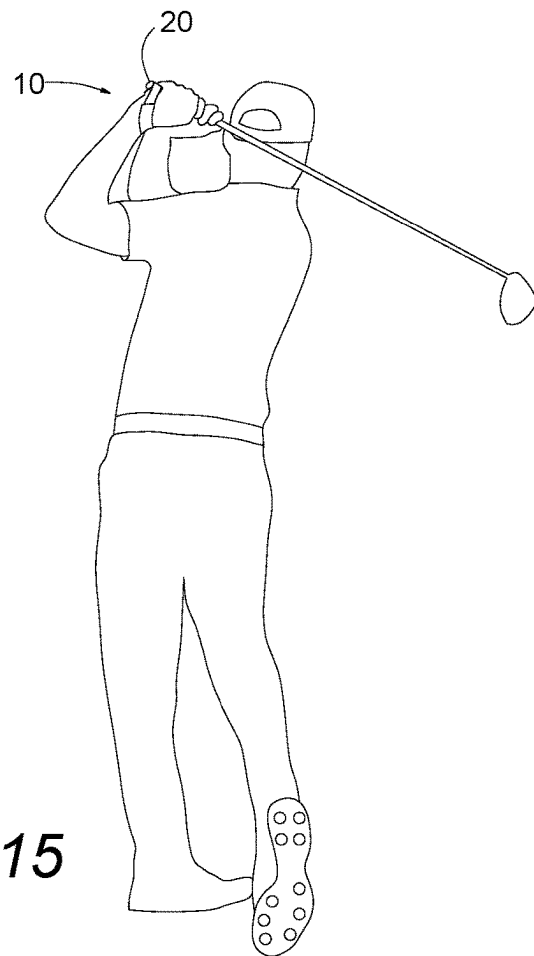


Fig. 15

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GOLF SWING BRACER**BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION****Field of the Invention**

The present invention relates to a bracer that assists a golfer to consistently execute a golf club swing proficiently.

Brief Description of the Prior Art

The wrists play an important part of a golf swing and have three types of movements: flexion/extension, pronation/supination and radial/ulnar deviation. Focusing on radial/ulnar deviation wrist movements, radial deviation is using only the wrist to move the thumb toward the forearm while, for example, holding a golf club. When the thumb moves away from the forearm while using only the wrist, the wrist movement is ulnar deviation. Radial/ulnar deviation is the most crucial wrist movements when executing a golf club swing to control golf swing radius, to increase golf club head speed and to maintain golf club face centeredness with the golf ball upon impact.

BRIEF SUMMARY OF VARIOUS PREFERRED EMBODIMENTS OF THE INVENTION

This section provides a general summary of the disclosure, and is not a comprehensive disclosure of its full scope or all of its features.

In accordance with the various embodiments of the present invention, a gripping method for holding a golf club grip involves slipping a bracer, consisting of a band formed of a material having an elastic restoring force covered with a sheath, over a golfer's lead hand and worn on the wrist. Bracer may be worn by left-handed golfers or right-handed golfers and used with or without a golf glove. In a preferred embodiment, the sheath partially encircling the band has first and second ends separated with a gap. A second step involves stretching and releasing the band over the end of the golf club grip such that the exposed band within the gap of the sheath has a hold on the golf club grip.

In some applications the material having an elastic restoring force is silicone and the band has a width ranging from $\frac{3}{4}$ " to 1" and a thickness of 2 mm and the sheath is formed of leather and is stitched along one side.

The band has a circumference in the range of 7 to 8 inches. For example, a circumference of 7" for golfers with smaller sized wrists and 8" for golfers with larger sized wrists.

The gripping method provides a number of different benefits including eliminating the golfer from having to excessively tighten their hand grip due to having a lack of hand gripping strength, thus allowing proper hinging of the wrists during the golfer's backswing. Other benefits include reducing ulnar deviation insufficiency and improving radial deviation muscle strength due to the elastic restoring force of the invention. The gripping method also assists new golfers to learn how much ulnar deviation and radial deviation to use during a golf swing.

The invention summarized above comprises the constructions and methods hereinafter described, the scope of the invention being indicated by the subjoined claims.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE SEVERAL VIEWS OF THE DRAWING

In the accompanying drawings in which one of various possible embodiments of the invention is illustrated, corre-

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sponding reference characters refer to corresponding parts throughout several views of the drawings in which:

FIG. 1 showing a golf swing bracer being worn and the precise moment in a golfer's backswing when radial deviation is executed, which is also the same point in a golfer's downswing when ulnar deviation is executed;

FIG. 1A is an enlarged detail taken from FIG. 1;

FIG. 2 is a perspective view of the golf swing bracer;

FIG. 3 is a side view of the golf swing bracer on the left wrist of a right-handed golfer;

FIG. 4 is a side view of the golf swing bracer on the right wrist of a left-handed golfer;

FIG. 5 is a top view (dorsal) of the golf swing bracer on the left wrist of a right-handed golfer;

FIG. 6 is a side view (radial) of the golf swing bracer on the left wrist of a right-handed golfer.

FIG. 7 is a bottom view (volar) of the golf swing bracer on the left wrist of a right-handed golfer;

FIG. 8 is a side view (ulnar) of the golf swing bracer on the left wrist of a right-handed golfer;

FIG. 9 is a side view (volar) of the golf swing bracer, when not in use, on the left wrist of a right-handed golfer holding a golf club;

FIG. 10 is a side view (volar) of the golf swing bracer stretched over a golf club grip;

FIG. 11 shows the right hand of a golfer gripping a golf club grip with wrist in radial deviation;

FIG. 12 shows the right hand of a golfer gripping a golf club grip with wrist in neutral position;

FIG. 13 shows the right hand of a golfer gripping a golf club grip with wrist in ulnar deviation;

FIG. 14 illustrates the end of golfer's powerful backswing as viewed from the front; and,

FIG. 15 illustrates the end of a golfer's powerful full swing as viewed from the rear.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF AT LEAST ONE PREFERRED EMBODIMENT OF THE INVENTION

Referring to the drawings more particularly by reference character, a bracer 10 for use in accordance with the present invention is shown in FIG. 2. Bracer 10 is formed from a band 12 of a material having an elastic restoring force such as silicone. Band 12 has a diameter such that it may be easily slipped over a golfer's lead hand and onto his or her wrist. The circumference of the band is selected accordingly to fit the wrist and will vary per individual. Commercially this may be done with two optional width sizes and two optional circumference lengths. Satisfactory results for use of bracer 10 have been obtained with a silicone band 12 having a width of $\frac{3}{4}$ " to 1", a circumference of 7" to 8" and a thickness of 2 mm. The preferred amount of resistance of the band 12 will also vary per individual and is determined by the nature of the material having an elastic restoring force, the width of the band, the circumference of the band and the thickness of the band. The width of the band may be narrower than $\frac{3}{4}$ " or wider than 1" and the thickness of the band may be greater or lesser than 2 mm depending which aforementioned golf swing issue(s) the golfer is addressing which are explained in greater detail in the following description sections.

With continuing reference to FIG. 2, a sheath 14 partially encircles band 12 with first and second ends 13a-13b separated by a gap 16, the gap 16 exposing a section of the band 12. Sheath 14 may be formed of a strip of tactually pleasant, breathable material stitched 18 along one edge.

Stitched **18** edge may be in conjunction with adhesive. Some materials such as nylons, plastics or other synthetic materials may be used but the preferred material is a layer of natural soft leather as it is well suited having durable, breathable and moisture deterrent characteristics.

FIGS. 3-8 show bracer **10** on a golfer's lead hand with the stitched **18** edge of sheath **14** toward the user's elbow and the smooth, curvature edge **22** toward the thumb as shown in FIG. 3. In FIG. 9 bracer **10** is on the lead hand of a right-handed golfer when not in use. For use in accordance with the present invention as an Adaptive Golf Swing Apparatus or as Golf Swing Training Apparatus as described below, band **12** is stretched at the gap **16** in the sheath **14** and released over the end of a golf club grip **20** as shown in FIG. 10. The positioning of band **12** on the end of the golf club grip **20** is individual preference as golf clubs vary in diameter and length. The sheath **14** pressing over the top of the golfer's wrist is important, as it provides a soft, breathable cushion.

1. When Used as an Adaptive Golf Swing Apparatus

Bracer **10** assists disabled, injured and elderly golfers who lack sufficient hand gripping strength, or who are unable to perform sufficient ulnar deviation (FIG. 13) in order to swing golf clubs properly and with confidence.

Insufficient Hand Gripping Strength

One example of the problems golfers have resulting from the lack of hand gripping strength is low ball speed due to the inability to grip the golf clubs tightly enough in order to execute a powerful downswing. Another example of the problems golfers have resulting from the lack of hand gripping strength is over-compensation by squeezing the golf club too tightly, restricting the proper hinging of the wrists needed when swinging golf clubs and resulting in a faulty putt when using a golf putter.

Ulnar Deviation Insufficiency

Golfers need to execute ulnar deviation (FIG. 13) at a precise moment during their downswing in order for the golf club face to make proper contact with the golf ball. Bracer **10** assists with ulnar deviation insufficiency during the golfer's downswing, as well as, assists with the natural timing thereof when to initiate ulnar deviation within the golf swing radius during the golfer's downswing by creating centrifugal force on the golf club head, resulting in a more precise un-hinging of the wrists in the exact proper moment.

2. When Used as a Golf Swing Training Apparatus

Bracer **10** assists new golfers who are learning to swing a golf club accurately and consistently by maintaining the exact same golf swing method each and every time (i.e. how much ulnar and radial deviation to use and precisely when to initiate ulnar and radial deviation during the golf swing) ultimately accelerating the development of muscle memory in less time and resulting in quickly mastering the proper golf swing.

Bracer **10** also assists experienced golfers who wish to change their golf swing method.

Radial Deviation

When golfers tee up their golf ball and position themselves into their golf swing stance, radial deviation (FIG. 11) is ever so slightly initiated in order for the golf club head to maintain a specific height from the ground in relevance to the golf ball height on the golf tee. Approximately midway during the golfer's actual backswing (FIGS. 1 and 1A) radial deviation is executed to the maximum range of motion, simultaneously resulting in bracer **10** to initiating maximum resistance created by elastic restoring force. Additionally, bracer **10** strengthens the muscles that execute radial deviation

tion by means of resistance while the golfer is actually playing golf. In the same way, bracer **10** can also be used as an exercise apparatus off the golf course to strengthen the muscles that execute radial deviation. The radial deviation resistance and gripping method induced by bracer **10** also assists golfers in bringing the golf club to a full stop at the end of powerful backswings (FIG. 14) and at the end of powerful full golf swings (FIG. 15) as well as, helps to prevent the golf club from slipping out of golfers' hands during powerful backswings, powerful downswings and powerful full swings.

In the preceding description, numerous specific details are set forth such as examples of specific components, devices, methods, in order to provide a thorough understanding of embodiments of the present disclosure. It will be apparent to a person of ordinary skill in the art that these specific details need not be employed, and should not be construed to limit the scope of the disclosure.

What is claimed is:

1. A gripping method for holding a golf club grip comprising

providing a band formed of a material having an elastic restoring force covered with a sheath, said sheath formed of leather and stitched along one side with a rounded opposite side edge, said band having a gap between a first and a second end exposing the band, slipping said band over a golfer's lead hand,

positioning the band on the golfer's lead hand such that the stitched along one side of the band is towards an elbow of the golfer's lead hand and the rounded opposite edge is positioned between golfer's lead hand and the golfer's wrist, and,

stretching the band in the gap over the end of the golf club grip such that the band in the gap has a hold on the golf club grip.

2. The gripping method of claim 1 further comprising providing a band wherein the material having an elastic restoring force is silicone and the band has a width range of ¾" to 1" and a thickness of 2 mm.

3. The gripping method of claim 1 further comprising providing a band wherein the band has a circumference of 7" to 8.

4. A gripping method for holding a golf club grip comprising

providing a band formed of silicone with an elastic restoring force, said band covered with a sheath, said sheath formed of leather and stitched along one side with a rounded opposite side edge, said band having a gap between a first and a second end exposing the band, said band having a width of about ¾" to about 1" and a thickness of about 2 mm,

slipping said band over the golfer's lead hand, positioning the band on the golfer's lead hand such that the stitched along one side of the band is towards an elbow of the golfer's lead hand and the round opposite edge is positioned between the golfer's lead hand and the golfer's wrist,

said band having a leather sheath with first and second ends partially encircling the circumference of the band with a gap between the first and second ends exposing the band, said band having a width of about ¾" to about 1" and thickness of about 2 mm; and,

stretching and releasing the band in the gap over the golf club grip such that the band in the cap has a hold on the golf club grip.

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